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Pfizer (PFE.N)

Framing expectations ahead of the MEVPRO-1 readout

CITI'S TAKE

Ahead of Pfizer's mevrometostat Phase 3 (MEVPRO-1) prostate cancer readout (YE26e), we frame the clinical and commercial bar for success. Indeed, Phase 1 results were encouraging, with mevrometostat plus Xtandi showing median radiographic progression-free survival (rPFS) of 14.3 months versus 6.2 months for Xtandi alone, although the small study and differences between patient groups warrant caution. Importantly, Phase 3 also compares the combination with docetaxel chemotherapy, which sets a higher bar than Phase 1, in our view. As such, we'd view a ~30% reduction (HR 0.7) in the risk of cancer worsening or death as clinically meaningful and ≥35% (HR ≤0.65) as commercially compelling. We believe strong efficacy with acceptable side effects could support upside to current estimates (VA cons 2032e: $1.3B) and greater confidence in the broader program. Conversely, weaker efficacy against docetaxel or difficult-to-manage side effects could pressure shares. Maintain Neutral, TP $27.

Phase 1 was strong, but some moderation would not surprise us - The 81-patient study showed an 8.1-month advantage in time without cancer worsening, an encouraging result that supports the Phase 3 study. However, follow-up was 9.6 months, only 34 progression/death events occurred, and more patients receiving the combination were fully active at enrollment, 63.4% versus 37.5%. These differences add uncertainty around the magnitude of the treatment effect, particularly given the small study. We don't think this negates the result, but would avoid expecting Phase 3 to reproduce the HR 0.51. Indeed, a smaller benefit could still be meaningful if accompanied by acceptable side effects and consistent benefit across the Xtandi and docetaxel comparisons.

Neutral	
Price (12 Oct 26 16:00)	US$28.40
Target price	US$27.00
Expected share price return	-4.9%
Expected dividend yield	6.1%
Expected total return	1.1%
Market Cap	US$161,871M

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Figure 1. Phase 1-to-Phase 3 bridge with a strong signal and important differences

Feature	Randomized Phase 1	Implication for MEVPRO-1
Patients	41 combination / 40 Xtandi	Larger Phase 3 dataset should improve precision
rPFS events	15 / 19; 34 total	Limited maturity in the original estimate
Median rPFS	14.3 / 6.2 months	Compelling proof of concept, not a Phase 3 forecast
rPFS HR	0.51; 90% CI 0.28–0.95	Considerable uncertainty around effect size
Median rPFS follow-up	9.6 months overall	Durability requires confirmation
Confirmed PSA50	34.1% / 15.4%	Supports incremental antitumor activity
Confirmed ORR	26.7% / 14.3%	Small measurable-disease populations
ECOG 0	63.4% / 37.5%	Potential prognostic advantage for combination
Gleason score ≥8	63.4% / 75.0%	Higher proportion in control
Prior taxane	43.9% / 45.0%	Broadly balanced
rPFS assessment	Investigator assessed	MEVPRO-1 uses BICR
Control	Xtandi alone	MEVPRO-1 includes Xtandi or docetaxel
Mevrometostat regimen	1,250 mg BID fasting	MEVPRO-1 uses 875 mg BID with food

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports

The control mix could matter nearly as much as the headline - MEVPRO-1 evaluates ~600 post-abiraterone mCRPC patients receiving mevrometostat 875 mg BID with food plus Xtandi versus physician's choice of Xtandi or docetaxel, with BICR-assessed rPFS. We suspect benefit may be larger against sequential Xtandi. Control-specific results therefore matter, but should be interpreted alongside prespecified stratification, baseline balance and confidence intervals rather than as separately powered trials.

Some success is already in estimates - Consensus already models $1.3B in 2032 sales, so a positive result may simply support existing forecasts rather than drive meaningful upside. We think a stronger result, particularly with clear benefits over both comparison treatments and manageable side effects, could support higher sales estimates and greater confidence in earlier use of mevrometostat. Conversely, a disappointing result would put existing sales expectations at risk.

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Figure 2. MEVPRO-1 outcome framework with scenario probabilities and potential stock reactions

Outcome	Illustrative efficacy profile	Other findings that matter	POS	Stock implications
Clear win	Statistically significant; HR ≤0.65; substantial absolute benefit	Consistency across intended controls; acceptable toxicity; no adverse OS signal; supports broader-program confidence	25%	+5% to +10%
Constructive	Statistically significant; HR ~0.66–0.70	Supportive absolute benefit and treatment delivery;primarily validates existing estimates	35%	0% to +5%
Mixed	Statistically significant, but smaller effect or limited absolute benefit	Benefit concentrated against Xtandi; incremental toxicity; commercial questions remain	20%	−5% to 0%
Disappointing	Primary endpoint miss, or unfavorable benefit-risk despite significance	Existing estimates at risk; weaker confidence in the broader MEVPRO program	20%	−10% to −5%

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Source: Citi Research

Tolerability could determine how broadly physicians use it – Taking mevrometostat with food maintained drug exposure while lowering peak levels versus the fasting regimen. Still, among 29 patients at the Phase 3 dose, Grade ≥3 treatment-related side effects occurred in 31.0%, serious related events in 13.8%, and 10.3% discontinued mevrometostat due to side effects. We'd argue that the key question is whether the benefit justifies adding long-term treatment to Xtandi. A modest improvement becomes less attractive if low blood counts, diarrhea or dose reductions make treatment difficult to sustain. We would therefore focus on how many patients remain on treatment at the intended dose. The small safety dataset makes Phase 3 important for establishing how well patients tolerate the combination over time.

Figure 3. Key nuances behind the headline MEVPRO-1 result

Nuance	Why it matters	What we would examine
Two control strategies	A pooled benefit may not imply equivalent differentiation against each treatment	Control allocation, HRs, medians and confidence intervals by intended comparator
Physician-selected comparator	Patients selected for each strategy may have different prognoses	Timing of control selection, randomization stratification and within-stratum balance
Subgroup precision	Lack of significance in a smaller subgroup does not establish lack of benefit	Prespecified analyses, CI width and interaction testing
Phase 1 maturity	Only 34 events supported the original HR	Phase 3 event maturity, censoring and Kaplan-Meier curves
Dose optimization	Lower Cmax does not establish elimination of toxicity	Exposure, dose intensity, interruptions, reductions and discontinuations
Chronic treatment burden	Cytopenias and GI effects could limit an otherwise convenient oral option	Grade ≥3 events, serious events, PROs and treatment duration
Resistance biology	Differential benefit could influence positioning and earlier-line confidence	Prior-abiraterone duration, prior taxane and exploratory molecular analyses
OS interpretation	Immaturity and subsequent therapies complicate survival assessment	OS maturity, subsequent-treatment balance and any adverse survival signal
Event-driven timing	Later events do not reveal which arm exceeded expectations	Actual cutoff and disclosed operational milestones

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Broader read-through is positive, but asymmetric - A strong result would validate the mechanism and regimen, with the clearest readthrough to ARPI-naïve mCRPC study MEVPRO-2. However, that trial tests adding mevrometostat to Xtandi in ARPI-naïve mCRPC rather than treating established post-abiraterone resistance. We suspect that distinction matters: Activity after resistance develops does not necessarily establish the same incremental benefit before resistance emerges. Read-through to ARPI-naïve mCSPC study MEVPRO-3 is less direct. In our view, longer potential exposure makes chronic safety particularly important, and a clean MEVPRO-1 tolerability profile would strengthen confidence in earlier-line feasibility without resolving the efficacy question. Conversely, a toxicity-driven disappointment would be more concerning across the program than a result limited by the docetaxel comparison. We'd therefore avoid applying the MEVPRO-1 HR directly to either earlier-line study.

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Pfizer

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Risks

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Fundamental Research

Analyst: Geoff Meacham, Ph.D.



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	16-Oct-23 00:00:00	2	*35.00	33.27
2	19-Dec-23 07:32:38	2	*28.00	28.16
3	13-Aug-24 16:30:02	2	*30.00	28.85
4	28-Jan-25 05:00:00	2	*29.00	26.75

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5	04-Feb-25 17:11:50	2	*27.00	25.87
6	11-Apr-25 05:00:00	2	*23.00	21.91
7	29-Apr-25 16:20:23	2	*25.00	23.79
8	05-Aug-25 15:49:11	2	*26.00	24.75

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
9	22-Sep-25 07:52:18	*--	-	24.04
10	01-Dec-25 16:11:30	*2	*26.00	25.27
11	28-Apr-26 12:38:18	2	*27.00	26.48

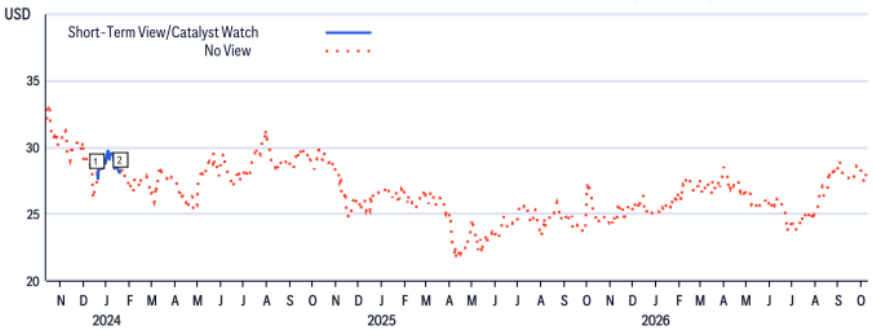
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Pfizer (PFE)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Geoff Meacham, Ph.D.



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	19-Dec-23 02:32:38	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	28.16

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
2	21-Jan-24 19:11:18	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	28.28

CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

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